The first week of May 2020 witnessed a few tense face-offs with the PLA. There had already been a face-off at PP-14 on 5 May, and a few days later on the North Bank of the Pangong Tso (Lake). These had seen some jostling, fisticuffs and even stone-throwing, resulting in minor injuries to both sides. At about the same time, there had been a face-off in Sikkim in the area of Naku La (Pass). All of these were the result of aggressive behaviour on the part of the PLA, which seemed to be looking for a fight. Till now, the moves were following the general pattern of resumption of patrolling activities with the onset of summer. Several PLA Brigade and Division equivalent formations had also been reported in their traditional training areas well to the rear. Our formations too were gearing up to induct into their training areas from their peacetime locations in the plains of Northern India. In this, the PLA had an advantage in that the Tibetan Plateau becomes negotiable earlier post-winter, as compared to our side, wherein movement is along treacherous and winding, avalanche-prone roads with high snow-bound mountain passes to be negotiated. As far as mobilization and movement time is concerned, the terrain definitely is in favour of the Chinese.

In the third week of May, in an extremely unusual move, the PLA established their presence in the Area of PP-15 and PP-17A in considerable numbers, with fifteen to twenty Armoured Personnel Carriers (APC), heavy vehicles, including dozers, and troops in the hundreds. These were areas where both sides used to patrol, observe for any untoward activity for a few hours and then fall back to their permanent bases; to Galwan in the case of the PLA and to Karan Singh (KS) Hill in our case. This area (Gogra/Hot Springs) had never been contested in the past. This sudden escalation was unprecedented as well as unwarranted. Reserve Companies and Battalions were moved

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